

Word family: **resilient / resilience / resiliency / resiliently**

Base word: resilient

Related forms: resilience, resiliency, resiliently

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / related noun and adverb forms (相關名詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “I think sea turtles are interesting because they are both fragile and **resilient** at the same time.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **resilient** means **able to survive, recover, and continue functioning despite difficulty, damage, stress, or harsh conditions**.

繁體中文： ** **面對困難、壓力、傷害或惡劣環境時，仍能承受、恢復並繼續生存 / 運作的；有韌性的**

中文翻譯：

> “They are both fragile and **resilient** at the same time.”

「牠們同時既脆弱，又非常**有韌性 / 有恢復力**。」

Here:

resilient = 即使受到壓力或挑戰，仍能撐過去並恢復的

1. **resilient = able to recover from difficulty (人 / 心理) — 有韌性的；復原力強的**

This is one of the central modern meanings.

Meaning: Able to recover emotionally or mentally after difficulty, disappointment, stress, or change.

Practice 1

> “Children can be remarkably **resilient** after difficult experiences.”

「孩子在經歷困難後可以表現出很強的**韌性 / 復原力**。」

Practice 2

> “She remained **resilient** despite several setbacks.”

「儘管遇到幾次挫折，她仍然非常**堅韌 / 有復原力**。」

resilient = 遇到壓力、失敗或困難後，仍能調整、恢復並繼續前進的

Common:

* resilient person

* resilient child

* emotionally resilient

* psychologically resilient

2. **resilient** = able to survive harsh conditions (生物 / 自然) — 耐受力強的；生命力強的

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “Sea turtles are both fragile and **resilient**.”

「海龜既脆弱，又非常**有韌性 / 生命力強**。」

Practice 4

> “This plant is surprisingly **resilient** in dry conditions.”

「這種植物在乾旱環境下出乎意料地**耐受力很強**。」

Practice 5

> “The species is highly **resilient** to environmental change.”

「這個物種對環境變化具有很強的**適應力 / 韌性**。」

resilient = 面對惡劣環境、傷害或生存壓力時，仍能存活、適應或恢復的

This is distinct enough from psychological resilience to show separately, though both share the same core idea of recovery/endurance.

3. **resilient** = able to return to original shape (物料) — 有彈性的；回彈力強的

This is the older/literal physical sense.

****Meaning:**** Able to bend, stretch, compress, or absorb force and then return to its original shape.

Practice 6

> “Rubber is a highly ****resilient**** material.”

「橡膠是一種****彈性很強 / 回彈力很高****的材料。」

Practice 7

> “The surface is soft but ****resilient****.”

「這個表面柔軟但很有****回彈力****。」

****resilient = 受壓或變形後能恢復原來形狀的****

This is a genuinely distinct physical sense and important for understanding the metaphorical extensions.

4. ****resilient = able to keep functioning despite disruption (系統 / 組織) — 抗衝擊的 ; 恢復力強的****

Systems, organizations, infrastructure, economies, networks, etc. can be ****resilient****.

Practice 8

> “The city needs a more ****resilient**** transport system.”

「這座城市需要一個更****有抗衝擊力 / 恢復力強****的交通系統。」

Practice 9

> “The company proved ****resilient**** during the crisis.”

「公司在危機期間顯示出很強的****韌性 / 恢復能力****。」

****resilient = 即使受到干擾、危機或損害，仍能維持功能或迅速恢復運作的****

This is a major modern institutional/systemic use.

5. **resilient = economically able to recover (經濟) — 經濟韌性強的 ; 復甦能力強的**

Practice 10

> “The local economy has remained **resilient**.”

「本地經濟一直保持很強的**韌性 / 復甦能力**。」

Practice 11

> “Small businesses can be surprisingly **resilient** during downturns.”

「小型企業在經濟低迷時有時出奇地**抗壓 / 有韌性**。」

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 4 under the broader **system continues/recover after disruption** sense.

The setting changes, but the mental concept remains the same.

Related form: **resilience**

Resilience is the main noun.

It has the same broad branches as **resilient**.

**resilience = psychological recovery (心理韌性) **

Practice 12

> “The experience strengthened her **resilience**.”

「這段經歷增強了她的**心理韌性 / 復原力**。」

**resilience = system/ecological recovery (系統 / 生態韌性) **

Practice 13

> “The study examines the **resilience** of coastal ecosystems.”

「這項研究探討沿海生態系統的**韌性 / 恢復能力**。」

**resilience = physical elasticity (回彈力) **

Practice 14

> “The material has excellent **resilience**.”

「這種材料具有很好的**回彈力**。」

resilience = 承受壓力、受損或變形後恢復的能力

Related form: **resiliency**

Resiliency is a variant noun meaning broadly the same as **resilience**.

Practice 15

> “The project focuses on community **resiliency**.”

「這個項目著重社區的**韌性 / 恢復能力**。」

For most general English:

> **resilience**

is the more common and preferred form.

I would include **resiliency** as a valid variant but not give it equal priority.

Related form: **resiliently**

Resiliently means in a resilient way, but it is relatively uncommon.

Practice 16

> “The community responded **resiliently** to the crisis.”

「社區以很有**韌性**的方式應對危機。」

In ordinary English, speakers often prefer:

> “with resilience”

or:

> “in a resilient way”

So **resiliently** is a lower-priority family form.

Important distinction: **resilient vs strong**

strong

means having power, strength, or resistance.

resilient

specifically emphasizes:

- * withstanding stress;
- * recovering afterward;
- * returning to function or shape.

Something can be strong but not resilient.

For example:

> a rigid material may be strong but brittle.

So:

strong = 強

resilient = 受壓後仍能恢復 / 有韌性

Important distinction: **resilient vs tough**

tough

emphasizes:

- * difficulty to damage
- * ability to endure hardship

resilient

emphasizes:

- * recovery
- * adaptation
- * bouncing back

A tough person may endure hardship without breaking.

A resilient person may be affected by hardship but recover well.

Important distinction: **resilient vs durable**

durable

means able to last a long time without wearing out or breaking.

resilient

means able to recover after pressure, damage, or disruption.

> durable shoes

> resilient material

Different emphasis.

Important distinction: **resilient vs adaptable**

adaptable

= able to change to fit new conditions.

resilient

= able to endure or recover from stress/disruption.

A species can be both:

* adaptable

* resilient

but these are not identical.

Important distinction: **resilient vs fragile**

This is the key contrast in your passage.

fragile

= easily damaged or harmed

resilient

= able to recover, endure, or continue despite damage or hardship

Importantly, they are **not absolute opposites**.

Something can be:

> **fragile and resilient**

at the same time.

For example:

* vulnerable to certain threats

* yet capable of surviving long journeys or recovering from stress

That is exactly the point of your sea-turtle sentence.

Important distinction: **resilient vs resistant**

resistant

means difficult to affect, damage, or change in the first place.

resilient

means able to recover after being affected.

So:

> resistance = withstand impact

> resilience = recover after impact

This distinction is especially useful in science, ecology, health, and systems language.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **resilient** *
* **resilience** *
* **resiliency** *

Lower-priority form:

* **resiliently** *

The Golden Manual says related forms should be included where they add real value, while domain uses should be merged when the same underlying concept still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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resilient — person/psychology	遇到壓力、失敗或困難後，仍能調整、恢復並繼續前進的
resilient — organism/ecology	面對惡劣環境、傷害或生存壓力時仍能存活、適應或恢復的
resilient — material	受壓、彎曲或變形後能恢復原來形狀的；有回彈力的
resilient — system/organization	受到干擾、危機或損害後仍能維持功能或迅速恢復運作的
resilience	承受壓力、受損或變形後恢復的能力；韌性 / 復原力
resiliency	resilience 的變體形式；較低優先度
resiliently	以有韌性、能恢復的方式；較少見

For your original sentence

> “I think sea turtles are interesting because they are both fragile and **resilient** at the same time.”

The exact meaning is:

resilient = 即使面對長途遷移、惡劣環境或其他生存壓力，仍有能力承受、適應並繼續生存

So:

> **fragile and resilient**

= **既容易受到傷害，又有很強的生存韌性和恢復能力**

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **resilient**:

1. **psychologically able to recover from difficulty**
2. **biologically/ecologically able to survive and recover**
3. **physically able to return to shape after pressure**
4. **systems/organizations able to keep functioning and recover after disruption**

I would merge economic/community/infrastructure resilience under #4, and keep **resilience / resiliency / resiliently** as family forms rather than inflate the base-word count.